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Test Cases Handoff Guide

Use this guide when you need to describe **scenarios that prove expected behavior, edge behavior, error behavior, or architectural fitness constraints**.

This guide is about evidence that the model or system behaves as intended.

KNOWLEDGE AREA

This guide helps with **proof that behavior works as expected**.

Guide family map

Where this guide sits in the full Blueprint Handoff Atlas family.

ROOT & CROSS-CUTTING

Handoff Atlas | Blueprint Bundle | Metamodel Vocabulary | Migrations

DESIGN

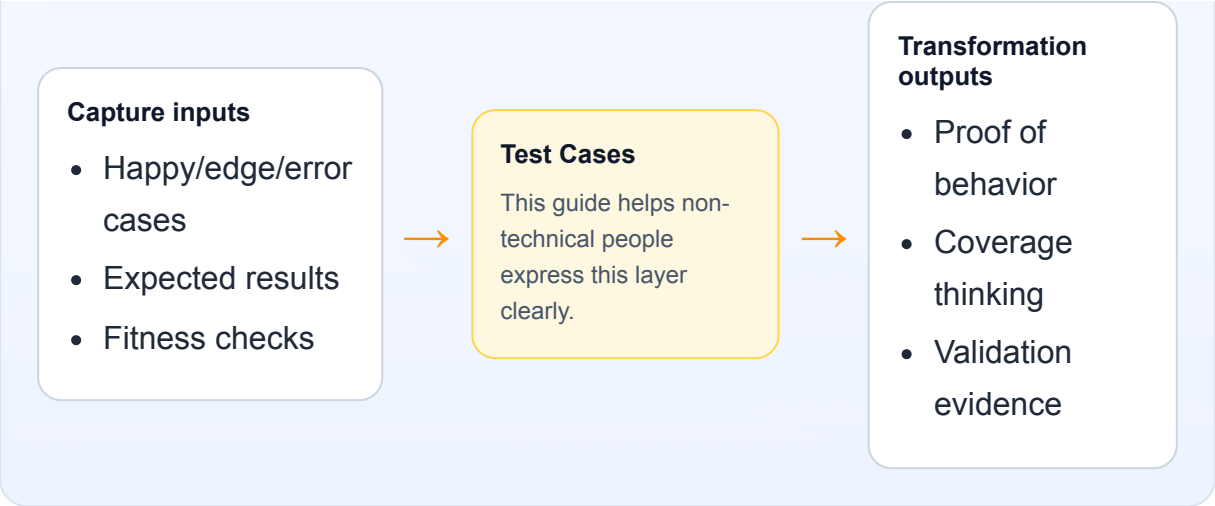
Architecture | Concepts | Domain | Dynamics | Infrastructure | Interactions | Models | Quality | Rules | Story

GOVERNANCE

Capability | Decisions | Motivation | Organization | Roadmap | Leverage | **Test Cases** | Value Stream

Capture → focus → transformation

What to gather first, what this layer focuses on, and what a modeler or AI agent can produce from it.



Main entities in this guide

- **Test Case** - one proof scenario with setup, action, and expected result.
- **Happy Path**, **Edge Cases**, and **Error Cases** - the three main suites used to group **Test Case** entries.
- **Fitness Function** - an automated constraint that checks the architecture or model itself.
- **Validates** - the typed links that say exactly which rules, operations, concepts, stories, or UI elements the test proves.
    - Often confused with: a **Finding** in Quality. A test case proves expected behavior; a finding records a weakness already discovered.

What belongs here

- happy-path scenarios
- edge-case scenarios
- error-case scenarios
- architectural fitness checks

What does not belong here

- a full business story without expected results
- vague quality wishes with no scenario or assertion
- implementation test code

Core things to capture

- the scenario name
- what is being tested

- setup/preconditions
- expected behavior or result
- what Blueprint element it validates

Core relationships to capture

- test case -> operation/rule/concept/story validated
- fitness function -> structural constraint checked
- scenario -> expected outcome or failure mode

Modus operandi

Capture evidence in scenario form:

1. describe the setup
2. describe the triggering action
3. describe the expected result
4. identify what Blueprint element is being validated
5. separate happy, edge, and error cases

Prompt set

- what scenario are we proving?
- what is the setup?
- what action occurs?
- what should happen?
- what rule, concept, or operation does this validate?

Free-text intake template

- **Test name:**
- **Category (happy/edge/error/fitness):**
- **Setup/preconditions:**
- **Trigger/action:**
- **Expected result:**
- **Validates:**

Worked example

- Happy path: customer submits a valid return request and receives confirmation
- Edge case: customer submits a request on the last allowed return day

- Error case: customer selects a non-returnable item and receives validation failure

Layer-specific handoff guidance

For test cases, the handoff should preserve **proof intent**.

The receiver should know:

- what scenario is being tested
- what the expected result is
- what blueprint element or rule it validates
- whether it is happy-path, edge, error, or fitness-focused

If a test note has no expected result, it is not a useful handoff yet.

How this becomes YAML

A technical modeler or AI agent can transform this into categorized test cases and fitness functions linked to the relevant Blueprint entities.

Common mistakes

- naming the test but not the expected result
- forgetting what is being validated
- mixing many scenarios into one case
- omitting edge and error behavior